

PLANT DICTIONARY

A complete listing of more than 8,000 plants, suitable for growing in temperate gardens worldwide. Includes full descriptions of the characteristics and cultivation of over 4,000 plants not already described in the Plant Catalog.

A

ABELIA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of deciduous, semievergreen or evergreen shrubs, grown for their foliage and freely borne flowers. Where marginally hardy, does best against a south- or west-facing wall. Requires a sheltered, sunny position and fertile, well-drained soil. Remove dead wood in late spring and prune out older branches after flowering to restrict growth, if required. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

A. 'Edward Goucher' illus. p.153.

A. floribunda. See *Vesalea floribunda*.

A. x grandiflora illus. p.113. **'Confetti'** is a small, semievergreen shrub. H and S 3ft (1m). Creamy-white-margined leaves are flushed pink in spring. Produces profuse clusters of soft-pink flowers from midsummer to midfall; attractive to bees and butterflies; Z6-10. **'Francis Mason'**, H 5ft (1.5m), S 6ft (2m), is vigorous and arching. Has coppery-yellow young shoots and ovate, yellowish-green leaves, darker in centers. Profuse, fragrant, bell-shaped flowers are white tinged with pink. Z6-9 **'Hopleys'**, H 5ft (1.5m), S 6ft (2m), is one of the hardest variegated cultivars, with dark green young leaves margined yellow, later becoming creamy white; Z7-11. **'Lake Maggiore'**, H 10ft (3m), S 12ft (4m), bears pink-tinged, white flowers, with pink calyces, from midsummer to fall. Z6-10 **A. parvifolia**, syn. *A. schumannii*, illus. p.154. **'Bumblebee'** is a deciduous, arching shrub. H 6ft (2m), S 10ft (3m). Pointed, mid-green leaves are bronze when young. In late summer-fall, bears yellow-blotched, lilac-pink flowers. Z6-10 **A. 'Raspberry Profusion'**. Compact, semievergreen, free-flowering shrub. H and S 4ft (1.2m). Produces a profusion of blush-pink flowers in late spring, with showy, raspberry-pink sepals; sepals are retained after the flowers drop, providing color into fall. Attractive to bees and butterflies. Z6-10 **A. schumannii**. See *A. parvifolia*.

A. triflora. See *Zabelia triflora*.

ABELIOPHYLLUM

White forsythia

OLEACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous shrub, grown for its winter flowers. Where marginally hardy, does best against a south- or west-facing wall. Needs plenty of

sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Thin out excess older shoots after flowering each year to encourage vigorous young growth. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

A. distichum. Deciduous, open shrub. H and S 4ft (1.2m). In late winter or spring produces fragrant, star-shaped, white flowers, tinged with pink, on bare stems; flowers may be damaged by hard frost. Leaves are ovate and dark green and often turn purple in fall. Z5-9

ABIES

Silver fir

PINACEAE

Genus of tall conifers with whorled branches. Spirally arranged leaves are needlelike, flattened, usually soft and often have silvery bands beneath. Bears erect cones that ripen in their first fall to release seeds and scales. See also CONIFERS.

A. alba. Fast-growing, conical conifer. H 80-130ft (25-40m), S 13-20ft (4-6m). Has silvery-gray bark and dull green leaves, silvery beneath. Cylindrical cones are 4-6in (10-15cm) long, ripening to red-brown. Z5-8

A. amabilis (Pacific fir). Conical conifer. H 65-100ft (20-30m), S 12-15ft (4-5m). Dense, notched, square-tipped, glossy, dark green leaves, banded with white beneath, are borne on hairy, gray shoots. Oblong, violet-blue cones are 3½-6in (9-15cm) long. Z6-8. **'Spreading Star'**, H 20in (50cm), S 12-15ft (4-5m), is a procumbent form suitable for ground-cover.

A. balsamea f. hudsonia (Hudsonia Group; Balsam fir) is a dense, dwarf conifer of flattened to globose habit. H and S 2-3ft (60cm-1m). Has smooth, gray bark and gray-green leaves that are semi-spirally arranged. Z3-6. **'Nana'** is another dwarf form that makes a dense, globose mound with leaves that are spirally arranged. Does not have cones.

A. cephalonica (Greek fir). Upright conifer with a conical crown; old trees have massive, spreading, erect branches. H 70-100ft (20-30m), S 15-30ft (5-10m). Sharp, stiff, glossy, deep green leaves are whitish green beneath. Cylindrical, tapered cones, 4-6in (10-15cm) long, are brown when ripe. Z5-6. **'Meyer's Dwarf'** (illus. p.105), H 20in (50cm), S 5ft (1.5m), has short leaves and forms a spreading, flat-topped mound.

A. concolor (White fir). Upright conifer. H 50-100ft (15-30m), S 15-25ft (5-8m). Has widely spreading, blue-green or gray leaves and cylindrical, green or pale blue cones, 3-5in (8-12cm) long. Z3-7

'Argentea' illus. p.95. **'Compacta'** (syn. A.c. 'Glauca Compacta'; illus. p.105), H to 6ft (2m), S 6-10ft (2-3m), is a cultivar with steel-blue foliage. **'Glauca Compacta'** see A.c. 'Compacta'. **'Violacea'** has bluish-white foliage when young.

A. delavayi (Delavay's fir). Upright conifer with tiered, spreading branches. H 30-50ft (10-15m), S 12-20ft (4-6m). Has maroon shoots and curved, bright deep green leaves, spirally arranged, with vivid silver bands beneath and rolled margins. Cones are narrowly cylindrical, 2½-6in (6-15cm) long, and violet-blue. Z8-9

A. forrestii (Forrest fir) illus. p.100.

A. grandis (Giant fir, Grand fir) illus. p.98.

A. homolepis (Nikko fir). Conifer that is conical when young, later columnar. H to 80ft (25m), S 20ft (6m). Pink-gray bark peels in fine flakes. Has pale green leaves, silver beneath, and cylindrical, violet-blue cones, 3-5in (8-12cm) long. Tolerates urban conditions. Z4-6

A. koreana (Korean fir) illus. p.104.

A. lasiocarpa (Subalpine fir). Narrowly conical conifer. H to 30ft (10m), S 10-12ft (3-4m). Has gray or blue-green leaves and cylindrical, violet-blue cones, 2½-4in (6-10cm) long. Z5-6. **var. arizonica 'Compacta'**, H 12-15ft (4-5m), S 5-6ft (1.5-2m), is a slow-growing, ovoid to conical tree with corky bark and blue foliage.

A. nordmanniana (Caucasian fir). Columnar, dense conifer. H to 130ft (40m), S 15ft (5m). Luxuriant foliage is rich green. Cylindrical cones, 4-6in (10-15cm) long, are green-brown, ripening to brown. Z4-6

'Golden Spreader', H and S 3ft (1m), is a dwarf form with a spreading habit and bright golden-yellow leaves.

A. procera (Noble fir) illus. p.95.

A. veitchii (Veitch fir) illus. p.96.

ABUTILON

MALVACEAE

Genus of evergreen, semievergreen or deciduous shrubs, small trees, perennials and annuals, grown for their flowers and foliage. Needs full sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water container-grown plants freely when in full growth, less at other times. In the growing season, young plants may need tip pruning to promote bushy growth. Mature specimens may have previous season's stems cut back hard annually in early spring. Tie lax-growing species to a support if needed. Propagate by seed in spring or softwood, greenwood or semiripe cuttings in summer. Whitefly and red spider mite may be troublesome.

A. 'Ashford Red' illus. p.137.

A. 'Golden Fleece'. Strong-growing, evergreen, rounded shrub. H and S 6-10ft (2-3m). Has maple- to heart-shaped, serrated, rich green leaves. Pendent, bell-shaped, yellow flowers are borne from spring to fall. Z10-11

A. 'Kentish Belle' illus. p.162.

A. megapotamicum illus. p.203.

A. pictum, syn. *A. striatum* of gardens. **'Thompsonii'** illus. p.324.

A. striatum of gardens. See *A. pictum*.

A. x suntense. Fast-growing, deciduous, upright, arching shrub. H 12ft (4m), S 10ft (3m). Has ovate, lobed, toothed, gray-green leaves. Produces abundant large, pendent, saucer-shaped, white to dark violet blue flowers, from late spring to early summer. Z13-14. **'Violetta'** illus. p.138.

A. vitifolium. Fast-growing, deciduous, upright shrub. H 12ft (4m), S 8ft (2.5m). Abundant large, pendent, saucer-shaped, white to purple-blue flowers are produced in late spring and early summer. Has ovate, lobed, sharply toothed, gray-green leaves. Z8-9. **var. album** illus. p.113.

'Veronica Tennant' illus. p.114.

ACACIA

Mimosa

MIMOSACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of evergreen and deciduous trees, shrubs and climbers, grown for their tiny flowers, composed of massed stamens, and for their foliage. Many species have phyllodes instead of true leaves. Requires full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring. Red spider mite and mealy bug may be problematic.

A. baileyana illus. p.92. **'Purpurea'** illus. p.84.

A. dealbata (Mimosa, Silver wattle) illus. p.211.

A. juniperina. See *A. ulicifolia*.

A. longifolia (Sydney golden wattle). Evergreen, spreading tree. H and S 20ft (6m). Has narrowly oblong, dark green phyllodes. Produces cylindrical clusters of golden-yellow flowers in early spring. Z9-11

A. podalyriifolia (Mount Morgan wattle, Queensland silver wattle). Evergreen, arching shrub. H 10-15ft (3-5m), S 10-12ft (3-4m). Has blue-green phyllodes and produces racemes of bright yellow flowers in spring. Z11

A. praviissima (Ovens wattle) illus. p.92.

A. pulchella (Western prickly Moses) illus. p.458.

A. ulicifolia, syn. *A. juniperina*. Evergreen, bushy shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 5ft